



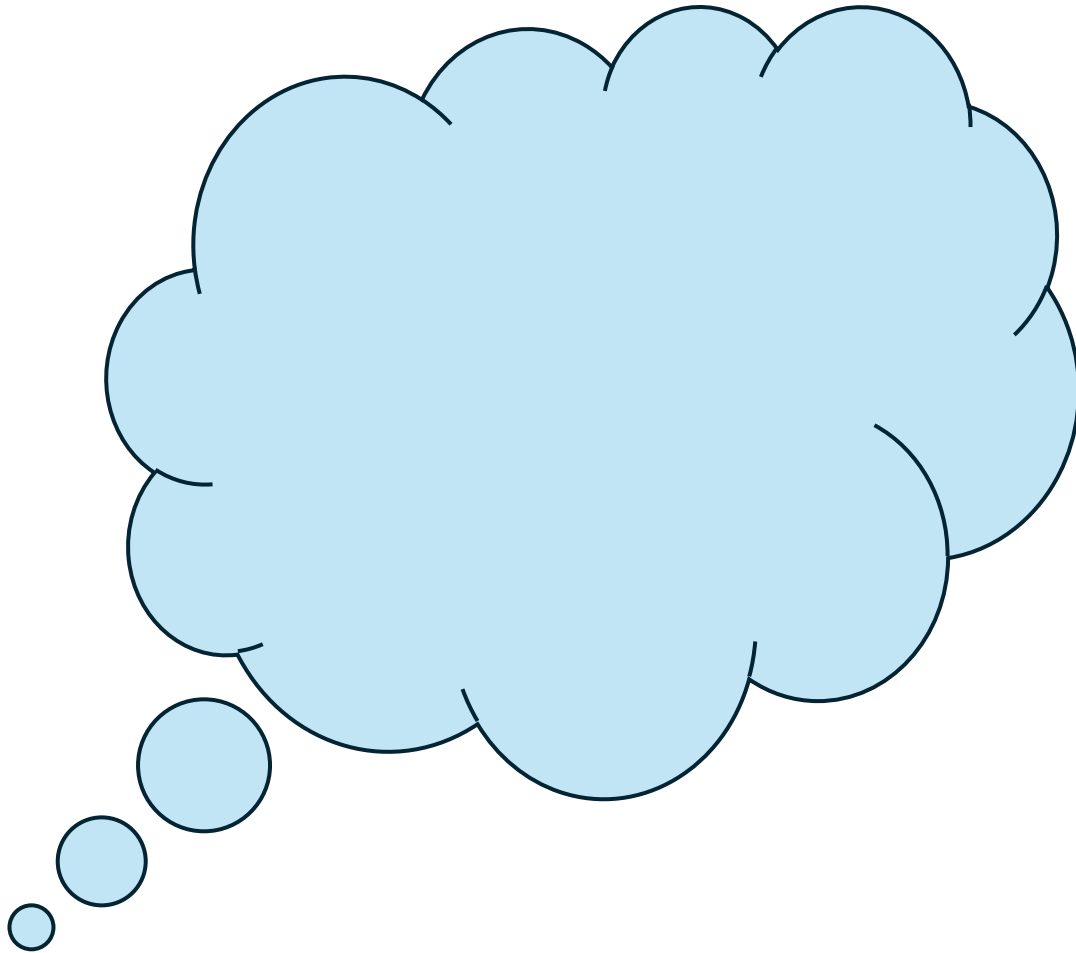
" Data for **good** "

vs.

Data for
co-liberation

Data **co-liberation**
includes community
leaders in the data
project, with money
and resources directly
managed or consulted
on by those affected
by the problem

What brings you here today?



Lauren: I often describe myself as a professional nerd. I worked in software development before going to grad school to study English, with a particular focus on early American literature and culture. (Early means very early—like, the eighteenth century.) As a professor at an engineering school, I now work on research projects that translate this history into contemporary contexts. For instance, I’m writing a book about the history of data visualization, employing machine-learning techniques to analyze abolitionist newspapers, and designing a haptic recreation of a hundred-year-old visualization scheme that looks like a quilt. Through projects like these, I show how the rise of the concept of “data” (which, as it turns out, really took off in the eighteenth century) is closely connected to the rise of our current concepts of gender and race. So one of my reasons for writing this book is to show how the issues of racism and sexism that we see in data science today are by no means new. The other reason is to help translate humanistic thinking into practice and, in so doing, create more opportunities for humanities scholars to engage with activists, organizers, and communities.²³

Catherine: I am a hacker mama. I spent fifteen years as a freelance software developer and experimental artist, now professor, working on projects ranging from serendipitous news-recommendation systems to countercartography to civic data literacy to making breast pumps not suck. I’m here writing this book because, for one, the hype around big data and AI is deafeningly male and white and technoheroic and the time is now to reframe that world with a feminist lens. The second reason I’m here is that my recent experience running a large, equity-focused hackathon taught me just how much people like me—basically, well-meaning liberal white people—are part of the problem in struggling for social justice. This book is one attempt to expose such workings of power, which are inside us as much as outside in the world.²²

Patricia Hill Collins & Black Feminist Thought (1990)

- Matrix of Domination:
 - Four domains of power in society.
 - Not only describes systems of power but also how an individual might experience them.



Matrix of Domination

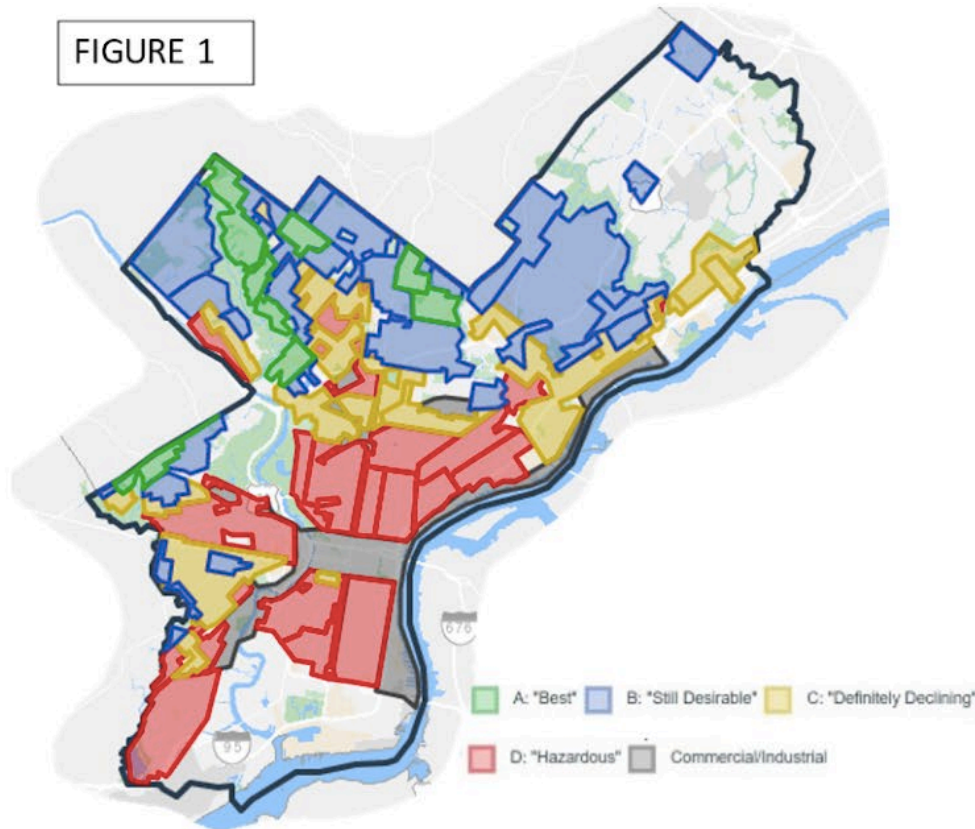
Table 1.1: The four domains of the matrix of domination¹⁴

Structural domain Organizes oppression: laws and policies.	Disciplinary domain Administers and manages oppression. Implements and enforces laws and policies.
Hegemonic domain Circulates oppressive ideas: culture and media.	Interpersonal domain Individual experiences of oppression.

Structural

1937 Assessment Grades from the Homeowners' Loan Corporation (HOLC)

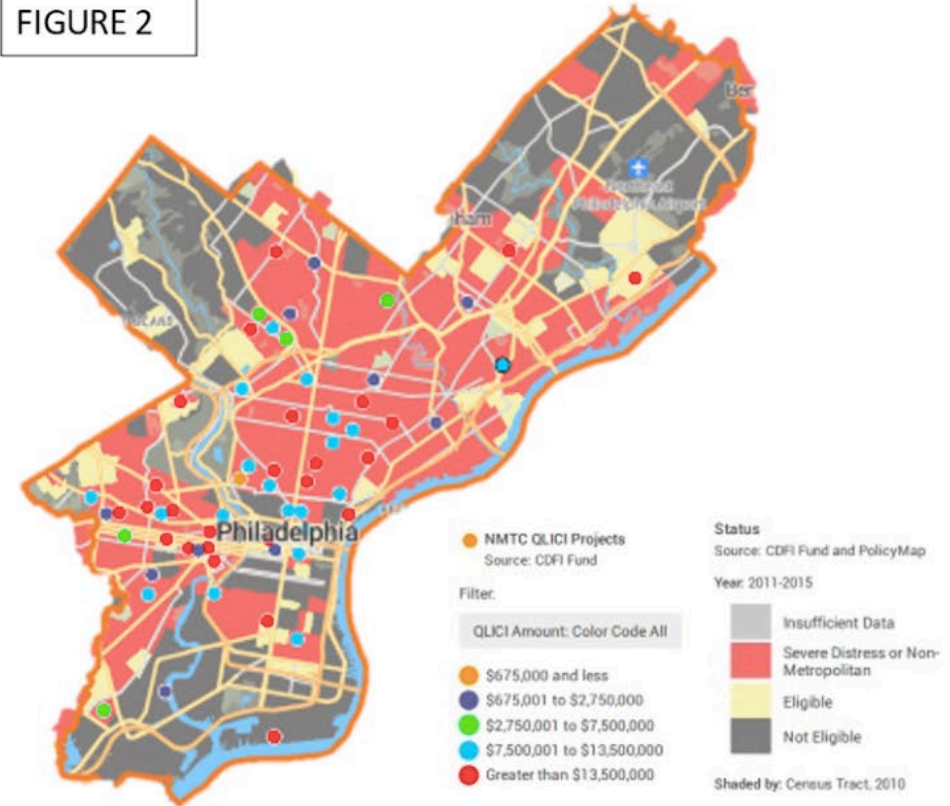
FIGURE 1



Sources: Mapping the Legacy of Structural Racism in Philadelphia, Office of Controller: Philadelphia (2020) Robert K. Nelson, LaDale Winling, Richard Marciano, Nathan Connolly, et al., "Mapping Inequality".

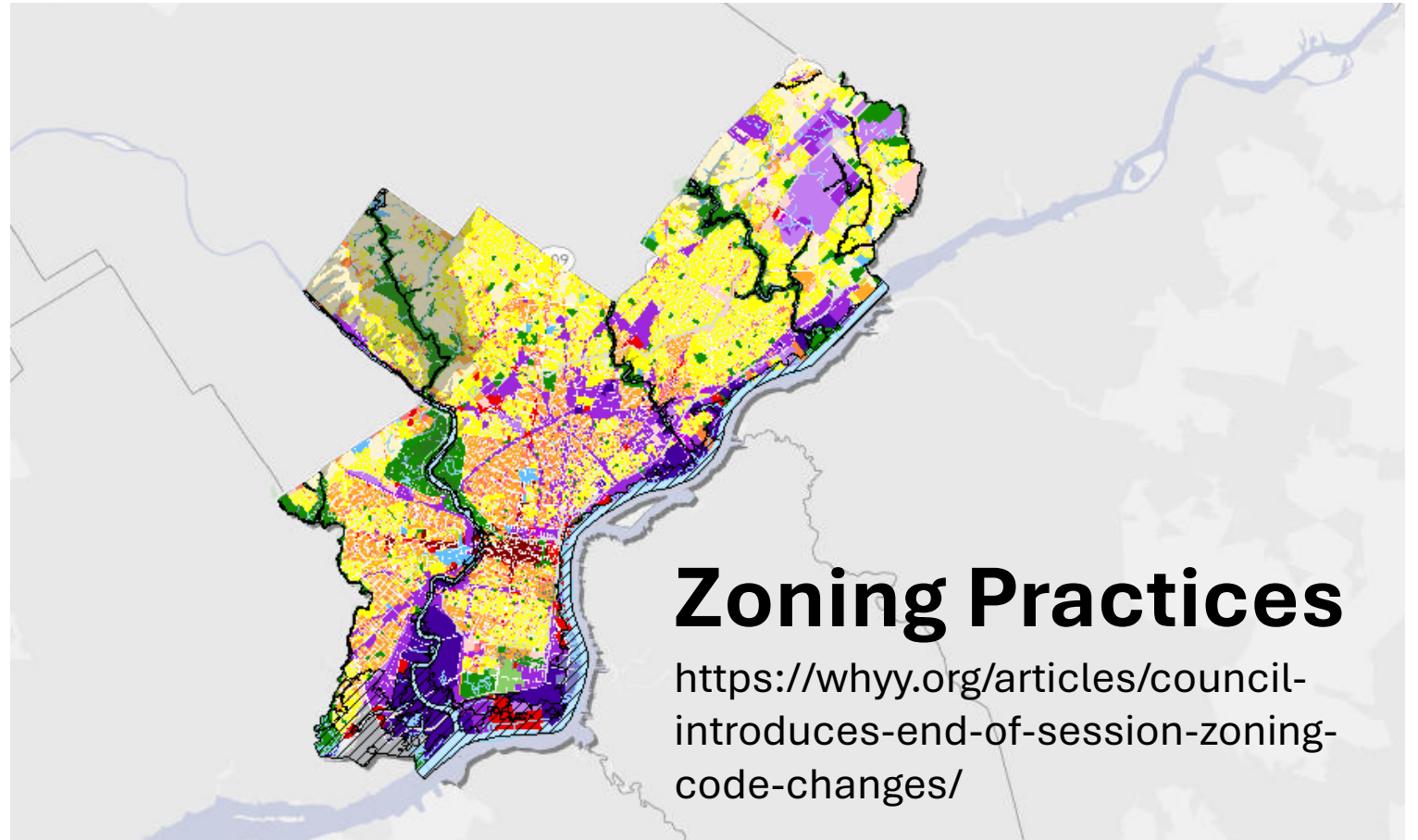
New Markets Tax Credit (NMTC) Program Eligibility for 2019, Using 2011- 2015 Eligibility Data

FIGURE 2



Sources: (2023) PolicyMap, NMTC Projects, CDFI Fund Data, Census Tract (2012), Philadelphia, PA.

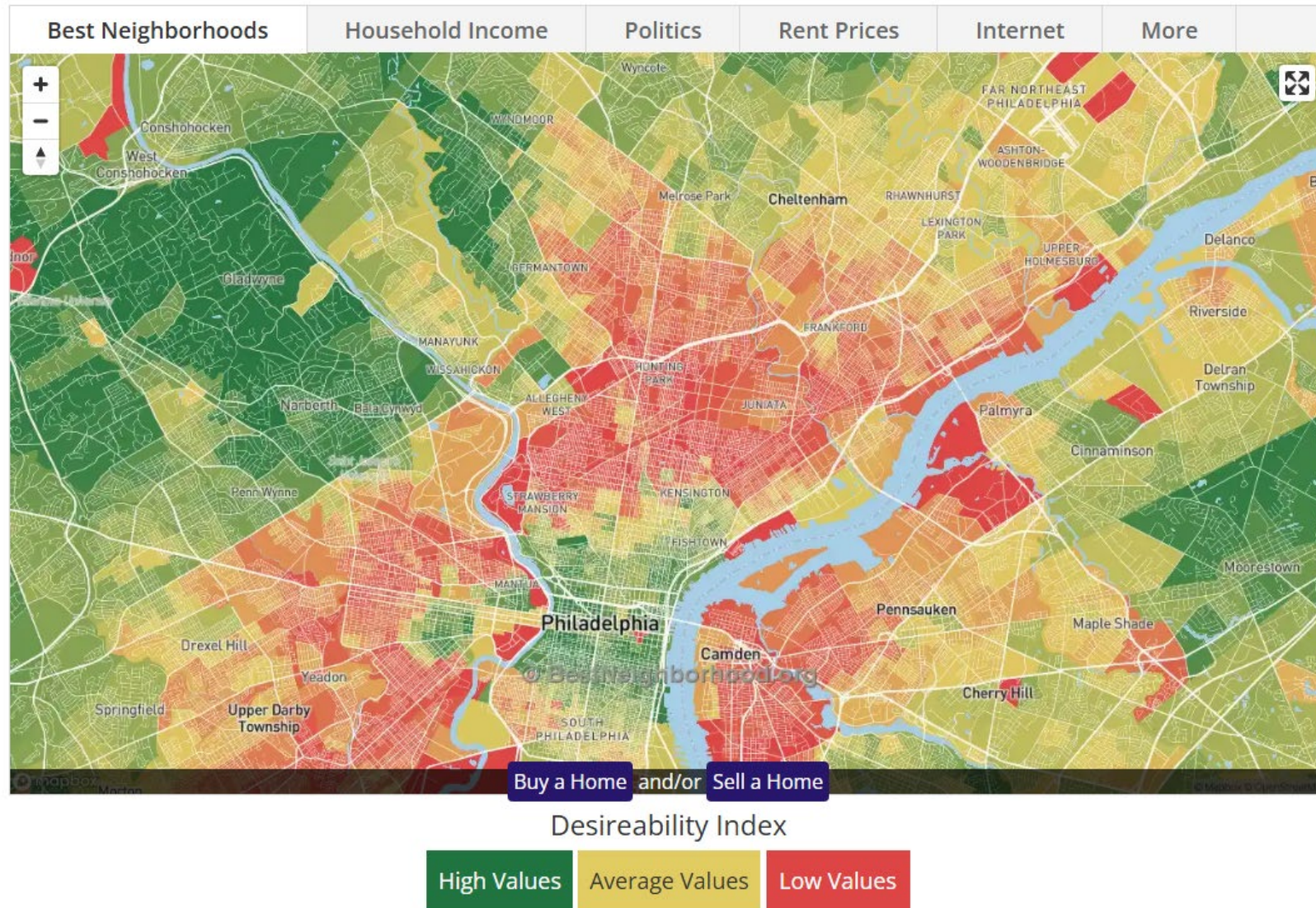
Disciplinary



Zoning Practices

<https://why.org/articles/council-introduces-end-of-session-zoning-code-changes/>

Hegemonic



Interpersonal



<https://philadelphia.coop/>

Things to Consider

- Biased data can mean that some people aren't being counted. Why would that be?
- Is data neutral?
- Who does the bulk of data science serve?
 - Three S's: Science, Surveillance, and Sales
- Privilege Hazard